सत्यमेव जयते

कर्मचारी भविष्य निधि संगठन

Employees Provident Fund Organisation

(श्रम एवं रोजगार मंत्रालय, भारत सरकार)

(MINISTRY OF LABOUR & EMPLOYMENT, GOVERNMENT OF INDIA)

मुख्य कार्यालय/**Head Office**

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To

All the ACCs (HQ)/ACC, Zonal Offices

Subject: Record Note of the meeting on "Audit of disposal of Pension on Higher Wages (PoHW) applications" held on 20.06.2025– Reg.

Madam/Sir,

Please find attached Annexure – I, i.e., the Record Note of the meeting on "Audit of disposal of Pension on Higher Wages (PoHW) applications" held on 20.06.2025 with all the ACCs (HQ)/ ACC of the Zonal Offices under the chairmanship of CPFC for kind information and necessary action please.

{This issues with the approval of Competent Authority}

Encl.: As above.

Yours faithfully,

25/07/25

(Abhay Ranjan)

Addl. Central P.F. Commissioner (Audit)

Copy to:

1. OSD to CPFC
2. PPS to ACC(HQ), Pension Division, Head Office
3. RPFC- I & RPFC-II (Pension), Head Office
4. PPS to FA&CAO/CVO.

5. All RPFC- I (Audit) in Zonal Offices.
6. All RPFC- I (Audit) in Head Office.
7. All RPFC- II (Audit) in Head Office.
8. All IAP teams of the Zones.
9. Director (OL): For Hindi Version of this circular.
10. E-office.epfo@epfindia.gov.in/ RPFC(e-office), Head Office

Annexure - I

Record Note of the meeting on "Audit of disposal of Pension on Higher Wages (PoHW) applications" held on 20.06.2025

A Video Conference (VC) was held under the chairmanship of CPFC with the Zonal ACC/ACC(HQs) commencing at 04:00 PM on 20.06.2025 (Friday) regarding Audit on Pension on Higher Wages (PoHW).

The following Officers attended the meeting from Head Office.

1. Shri Ramesh Krishnamurthi, CPFC
2. Shri Chandramauli Chakraborty, ACC(HQ) Pension
3. Shri Abhay Ranjan, ACC (Audit)
4. Shri Soumya Kanti Gupta,RPFC-I (Pension)
5. Shri Amitabh Prakash, RPFC-I (Audit)
6. Shri Amul Raj Singh, RPFC-I (Audit)
7. Shri Hemant Madhukar Tirpude, RPFC-I (Audit)
8. Shri Muhammed Majaz, RPFC-II (Audit)
9. Shri Shubham Agrawal, RPFC-II (Pension)
10. Shri Keshar Singh, RPFC-II (Audit)

1. At the outset, ACC(HQ) Pension informed that Audit of disposal of the PoHW applications is to be initiated as desired by the MoLE and also considered by the Pension & EDLI Implementation Committee (PEIC). He shared that it has been decided to have such cases audited by the Internal Audit Parties through a special exercise in a time-bound manner before 30 September 2025.
2. CPFC emphasized that this work should be accorded the highest priority. In order to get the task completed on priority, he suggested that:

- The disposal of PoHW applications pertaining to the Exempted Establishments may be audited at an early stage as the disposal of such cases would have been predominantly based on the applicable Trust Rules and similarly the cases of Validation of Options can also be audited initially. This strategy would allow a significant portion of the overall Audit workload to be efficiently addressed on priority.
- In view of the shortage of human resources in existing IAPs, the concerned Zonal Offices having jurisdiction over the Internal Audit Parties (IAPs) may provide the field office staff (AO/EO & SS/Sr.SSA) to assist the IAPs for completing this special exercise within time.
- ZOs may suitably modify the IAP calendars and daily supervise & monitor the working of the IAPs to accord topmost priority to this task and ensure timely completion of this special exercise **by 30th September 2025.**
- While auditing the allowed cases, among other aspects, the following points may also be verified:
    - Delay in the issuance of Demand letters, if applicable.
    - Delay & correctness in the issuance of PPOs.
    - Disbursement of Arrears and Pension.

3. With respect to the disposal of pending PoHW applications, CPFC instructed that -

- ZOs should closely monitor and ensure that all pending PoHW applications shall be

disposed of **by 30th June 2025.**

- In allowed cases, ZOs should ensure that the work related to issuance of Demand Letters, issuance of PPOs and Disbursement of Arrears and Pension must be completed at the earliest on priority.

4. Thereafter, a presentation (PPT) was given by the RPFC – I (Audit) on the Audit of disposal of PoHW applications and the following points were highlighted:

a. Objective is to verify whether the PoHW applications were disposed of in accordance with the directions of the Hon'ble Supreme Court dated 4th Nov. 2022, relevant Rule provisions, and various HO instructions.
b. ZO should prioritize the Office wise/Establishment wise workload.
c. ZO should Plan the Audit by IAPs and may revise the Audit Calendar as required.
d. ZO may provide the Field staff (AO/EO & SS/Sr.SSA – preferably 02 AO/EOs and 2 SS/Sr.SSA) to assist the IAP teams for timely conduct of the said audit exercise.
e. Priority to be accorded to the audit of applications from the Exempted Establishments where no. of applications is higher and the disposal is primarily based upon the extant Trust Rules.
f. Similarly, the cases of Validation of Options can also be audited initially.
g. Daily and Weekly reports of cases audited are to be submitted by IAPs to the ZOs and the ZOs will check, compile and send to Audit Division, HO on a Google Sheet/ NIC Collab sheet.
h. ZOs to daily supervise & monitor the working of the IAPs to accord topmost priority to this task and ensure timely completion of the special exercise by **30th September 2025.**

5. RPFC-I, RO, Jabalpur shared that for cases pertaining to Branch Units of Exempted Establishments covered u/s 2A of the Act, the decision should have to be on the basis of the Trust Rules of the main Establishment covered u/s 1(3)(a)/1(3)(b) of the Act. ACC(HQ) Pension responded that clarification in this regard has already been issued to the field offices by the Pension Division.

6. ACC, Zonal Office, UP requested that a checklist and one-day training may be given to the audit team for standardizing the procedure. ACC(HQ) Pension responded that they will be undertaking briefing of the audit teams in due course. CPFC asked Pension and Audit Divisions to prepare the check points. ACC, Audit, Head Office highlighted that in the meantime in order to expedite, all ZOs should get conducted the audit of the disposal of the PoHW applications from the Exempted establishments disposed on the basis of the applicable Trust Rules and also the PoHW cases of validation of Options i.e. Pre 01.09.2014 cases, immediately on priority.

7. ACC, Zonal Office, Gujarat said that the ongoing Internal Audit may be kept in abeyance, in order to ensure the timely completion of this exercise. ACC, Audit, Head Office responded that ongoing IAP work should continue along with this special audit exercise. CPFC emphasized that the audit of disposal of PoHW applications be accorded the utmost priority while ensuring the ongoing conduct of IAP work.

8. RPFC-I, RO, Patancheru raised the issue of many ROs not replying to the PoHW case related communications from RO Patancheru citing it as a major reason for the pending cases. He stated that using e-office instead of e-mail will expedite the process of disposal and aid in tracking of applications and retrieval of information. CPFC directed that all pending references among Regional Offices regarding PoHW matters

should be cleared without delay. ZOs should also communicate to the respective ZOs in this regard.

9. It was also discussed that in the coming weeks Audit and Pension Divisions in Head Office should get the following tasks crystalized:

a. Audit & Pension Divisions, Head Office shall have interactions with the ZOs and IAPs on the special exercise of Audit of disposal of PoHW applications.
b. Audit Division will be sharing a reporting format with the Zonal Offices for daily and weekly reporting of the conduct of this special audit work by IAP.
c. A checklist with broad pointers for this special Audit will be provided soon.

10. Concluding the discussion, CPFC re-iterated with emphasis that all pending PoHW applications shall be got disposed of **by 30th June 2025** by concerned offices and the special audit of disposal of PoHW applications should be completed before **30th September 2025** according high priority.

The meeting concluded with thanks to the chair.